

OptionsAgent trades a defined-risk options framework on a **\$100,000 Alpaca paper account** (re-funded Aug 28, 2026). The system runs two completely isolated engines: **Engine 1 (Credit-Spread Seller)** sells 30 to 45 DTE vertical spreads across 13 liquid underlyings under \$50, where Claude proposes directional conviction while fixed Python rails select all strikes, deltas, and sizing; and **Engine 2 (0DTE ORB Scalper)** trades pure momentum breakouts on SPY and QQQ intraday with zero LLM involvement.

ENGINE 1 EXECUTION PIPELINE (DAILY SELLER, 10:15 TO 10:27 ET)

DETERMINISTIC RAILS AND WINNER GATE

STEP 01

Cron Wakes It

Runs weekdays **10:15 to 10:27 ET** via local crontab with an atomic once-per-day lock file. Fails closed if the broker clock check fails or market is closed.

STEP 02

Chain Snapshot

Archives full option chains (quotes, IV, greeks) for all **13 watchlist names** to disk and builds a structured market context bundle per symbol.

STEP 03

Claude Proposes

Local Claude Code CLI (**sonnet**, no tools, no web) proposes only **ticker, direction, conviction (0 to 1), and thesis**. Strikes and size are strictly banned.

STEP 04

Rails Sizing Gate

Conviction floor **0.60** (below = veto), max **6 positions**, phase allowlist. Sizing scales linearly from **30% to 100%** of free options buying power.

STEP 05

Contract Selection

Short leg **15 to 30 delta**, width capped at **\$2.00, 30 to 45 DTE**. Put spread if bullish, call spread if bearish. Single MLEG combo limit order (prefix **oa-**).

STEP 06

Winner Profile Gate

Spread must match replayed winners: **CCL put** (credit ≥ \$0.29, width ≥ \$1.50), **SOFI put** (credit ≥ \$0.23, width ≥ \$1.00), or **F call** (credit ≥ \$0.06, width ≤ \$0.50).

ENGINE 1 EXIT SWEEP (EVERY 20 MIN DURING MARKET HOURS, NO LLM)

SELLER EXITS

Profit target at **50% of credit received**; stop loss at **2x credit** evaluated only from 10:00 ET and requiring **two consecutive sweeps to confirm** (protects against transient wide quotes); mandatory force close at **21 DTE**; and proactive dividend checks closing short calls prior to ex-dates. Worst case per spread is width minus credit (~\$200), bounding 6 positions near \$1,200 (1.2% account risk).

ENGINE 2 0DTE ORB SCALPER (ARMED AUG 28, 12:25 ET, NO LLM)

SCALPER INTRADAY

Fully isolated (own state, registry, prefix oas-). Trades **0DTE ATM SPY and QQQ** on 09:30 to 09:33 ET opening range breakout. Requires 1-min bar close outside range with **volume ≥ 1.5x session avg**, confirmed by next bar and VWAP. Fixed **\$250/trade**, max 2/day, 1 open, no entries at/after **11:30 ET**. Exits: +50% target, -30% stop (-60% if thesis holds), 15-min theta cut, mandatory **15:50 ET flatten**. Split feeds: SIP data key plus Public.com chain sidecar.

KEY GOVERNING PARAMETERS

Account Equity	\$100,000 (Alpaca Paper)
Seller Conviction Floor	0.60 (below = veto)
Seller Sizing Scale	30% to 100% of free BP
Max Concurrent Spreads	6 positions (bound ~\$1.2k)
Spread Rails	Delta 15-30, Width ≤ \$2, 30-45 DTE
Seller Exits	50% gain, 2x stop (2 sweeps), 21 DTE
Scalper Allocation	\$250 / trade, max 2 / day
Scalper Cutoffs	No entry ≥ 11:30, flat 15:50 ET

WATCHLIST AND RAILS

F

T

PFE

VZ

CMCSA

KVUE

SOFI

CCL

AAL

WBD

MARA

EWZ

KWEB

✗

Let model output choose strikes, expiries, or order size

✗

Loosen any risk rail via config (env vars may only tighten)

✗

Route live-money orders (broker client refuses non-paper)

✗

Enter scalps after 11:30 ET or hold 0DTE past 15:50 ET

A REAL DAY (AUG 28, 2026)

Claude proposed **8 credit spreads** (T, CMCSA, WBD, VZ, PFE, MARA, CCL, AAL). Deterministic rails executed **0**: 3 found no contract matching delta, width, and credit rules; 5 failed the winner profile gate. Meanwhile, the exit sweep closed July's SOFI spread for **+\$26.58**. Vetoing non-compliant setups is the system working as designed. The 0DTE scalper was armed at 12:25 ET after verifying sub-minute SIP feeds; its first live entry window is Monday 09:33 ET.

Frequently Asked Questions

Operational mechanics, risk constraints, and architectural safeguards verified directly from the code.

ENGINE 1 RAILS

ENGINE 2 SCALPER

FAIL-CLOSED DESIGN

Q1 Is this real money?

No. OptionsAgent operates strictly on an Alpaca paper account (`$100,000` balance, re-funded Aug 28, 2026). The Python broker client validates environment keys at startup and unconditionally refuses non-paper endpoints. No live capital is ever at risk.

Q2 What exactly does the LLM control?

The local Claude Code CLI (`sonnet`) acts solely as a directional idea generator. It receives an isolated JSON bundle and proposes only `{underlying, direction, conviction, thesis}` . Output is schema-validated; the LLM cannot name strikes, deltas, or sizes. Parsing failure yields zero trades. The scalper uses no LLM at all.

Q3 Why credit spreads?

Day-one operational testing with a single-leg MARA long put suffered severe theta decay, losing 37.6% of premium. The architecture pivoted to defined-risk credit spreads, capturing positive time decay while capping maximum loss to spread width minus credit.

Q4 How does sizing work?

Position budget is a conviction-scaled share of available options buying power. At the `0.60` conviction floor, sizing receives 30% of free BP, scaling linearly to 100% at `0.85+` . Contracts equal budget divided by (width × 100). If budget yields under 1 contract, the trade is skipped.

Q5 100% of buying power sounds aggressive.

It is deliberate operator policy: "use all the cash, not necessarily all at once." Structural brakes prevent reckless exposure: \$2.00 maximum spread width (~\$200 loss cap), 6-position ceiling, broker BP rejection, and an optional tighten-only kill switch (`QA_MAX_POSITION_USD`).

Q6 What is the winner profile gate?

Historical replay of July fills isolated three profitable setups: **CCL bullish puts** (credit ≥ \$0.29, width ≥ \$1.50), **SOFI bullish puts** (credit ≥ \$0.23, width ≥ \$1.00), and **F bearish calls** (credit ≥ \$0.06, width ≤ \$0.50). All other proposals fail closed. This is a deliberate in-sample overfit frozen to gather clean out-of-sample evidence.

Q7 Walk me through the exits.

Seller: 20-min sweeps without LLM enforce ex-dividend risk checks first, **50% profit target**, **2x credit stop** (evaluated from 10:00 ET and confirmed across 2 consecutive sweeps to prevent bad-tick stops), and **21 DTE force close**. Scalper: +50% target, -30% stop (-60% if breakout intact), 15-min theta cut, and mandatory 15:50 ET flatten.

Q8 Assignment and overnight gap risk?

Verticals are defined-risk: max loss is width minus credit regardless of assignment mechanics. The 2x stop is a loss control, not a guarantee. An overnight gap through short strikes costs the full width (~\$200/spread). Six positions bound worst-case catastrophic loss near \$1,200 (1.2% of account). Scalper never holds overnight.

Q9 Is there a daily loss limit?

Seller: no dedicated loss cap, as risk is bounded structurally by the \$2 width limit, 6 positions, single entry window, and winner gate. Scalper: strictly bounded to 2 trades of \$250 each (\$500 max daily risk before exits). An emergency halt can be re-enabled via environment variables.

Q10 What does the ODTE scalper actually do?

Engine 2 is a fully isolated system (prefix `oas-` , zero LLM) trading ODTE ATM SPY and QQQ. It marks the 09:30 to 09:33 ET opening range, entering on 1-min breakout with volume ≥ 1.5x avg confirmed by the next bar and VWAP. \$250/trade, max 2/day, 1 open, no entries ≥ 11:30 ET (12 of 12 historical late entries lost), mandatory flatten at 15:50 ET.

Q11 How do I know what it did on any given day?

Through the read-only dashboard at `127.0.0.1:8765` and structured JSONL logs: `data/decisions.jsonl` (every proposal and veto reason), `data/structures.jsonl` (open/closed credit spreads), plus `data/scalp_decisions.jsonl` and `data/scalp_positions.jsonl` for intraday scalps.

Q12 What stops a bug from doing something catastrophic?

Hard-coded Python rails (env can only tighten constraints), broker client refusing non-paper endpoints, single locked daily entry window, exit sweeps reconciling local registry against broker positions with alerts on vanished legs, and scalper force-flattening at 15:50 ET while auto-recovering orphaned positions.



OptionsAgent

Multi-day credit spread seller

PAPER - ACTIVE

Overview

Positions

Trade history

Research

Risk rails

System

Friday, August 28

2026

Paper account

12:27 PM ET

Today P/L

+\$0

Realized, market open

Open spreads

0 of 6

Total open positions

Buying power

\$100,000

Available to deploy

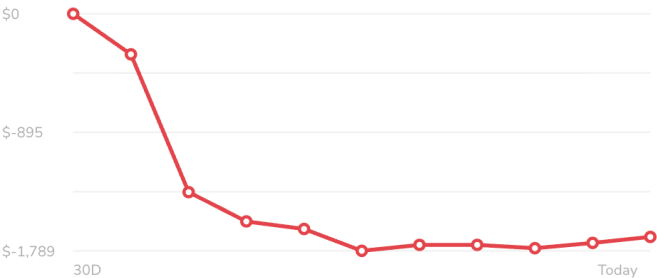
Profile status

3 winner rules

Active

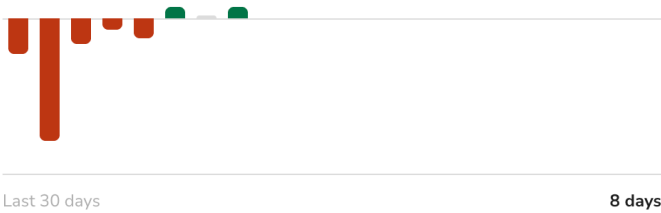
Equity curve

30D



Daily P/L, realized

30D



Credit spread history

View all →

Research replay



OptionsAgent

Multi-day credit spread seller

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OptionsAgent v1.0.0

Friday, August 28

2026

Paper account

12:27 PM ET

Positions

Live paper positions from the broker snapshot.

Overview

SYMBOL	STRATEGY	QTY	MARKET VALUE	COST BASIS	STATUS
No broker positions reported.					

Read-only dashboard - Account data is cached and never used to submit orders.



Multi-day credit spread seller

PAPER - ACTIVE

Overview

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Friday, August 28

2026

Paper account

12:27 PM ET

Trade history

Overview

Closed structures from the append-only registry. Unknown P/L stays unknown.

SYMBOL	TYPE	WIDTH	CREDIT	P/L	EXIT
SOFI	Credit Spread	\$0.50	\$0.08	—	8/28/2026, 9:40 AM
F	Credit Spread	\$0.50	\$0.06	+\$45	7/31/2026, 1:20 PM
SOFI	Credit Spread	\$1.00	\$0.23	+\$40	7/31/2026, 9:40 AM
MARA	Credit Spread	\$1.00	\$0.23	-\$25	7/31/2026, 9:40 AM
SOFI	Credit Spread	\$0.50	\$0.11	+\$0	7/30/2026, 9:40 AM
CCL	Credit Spread	\$1.50	\$0.29	+\$45	7/28/2026, 11:40 AM
AAL	Credit Spread	\$1.00	\$0.19	-\$165	7/23/2026, 10:20 AM
AAL	Credit Spread	\$1.00	\$0.19	-\$57	7/16/2026, 10:20 AM
VZ	Credit Spread	\$1.00	\$0.17	-\$221	7/10/2026, 9:40 AM

OptionsAgent

Multi-day credit spread seller

PAPER · ACTIVE

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Friday, August 28

2026

Paper account

12:27 PM ET

Research replay

Conditional realized replay; not a full backtest or durable edge claim.

Overview

Replay summary

Entry days	5
Archived records	10
Realized P/L	-\$644
Filtered profile replay	+\$130
Unknown P/L closes	1

Winner rules

CCL bullish · width ≥ \$1.50 · credit ≥ \$0.29	Active
SOFI bullish · width ≥ \$1.00 · credit ≥ \$0.23	Active

OptionsAgent

Multi-day credit spread seller

PAPER · ACTIVE

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OptionsAgent v1.0.0

Friday, August 28

2026

Paper account

12:27 PM ET

Overview

Risk rails

Deterministic gates remain in code and the bot is paper-only.

Deterministic hard rails

Rollout phase	credit_spreads_only
Conviction floor	0.6
Maximum concurrent positions	6
Mandatory close	21 DTE
Execution mode	PAPER ONLY

Read-only dashboard · Account data is cached and never used to submit orders.

OptionsAgent explainer, built from the code and live account, Aug 28 2026

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OptionsAgent

Multi-day credit spread seller

PAPER · ACTIVE

Overview

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Risk rails

System

Friday, August 28

2026

Paper account

12:27 PM ET

System

Runtime health and market-data provider status.

Overview

Runtime

Trading gate	Enabled
Broker mode	Paper
Market-data provider	public
Snapshot	8/28/2026, 12:27:34 PM ET
Refresh failures	0

Read-only dashboard · Account data is cached and never used to submit orders.

OptionsAgent v1.0.0